PRE-PURCHASE INSPECTION CHECKLIST

Land Rover LR3 / Discovery 3

2004–2009 (US: 2005–2009) · L319 · LR3 · Discovery 3 · 4.4 V8 · 4.0 V6 · 2.7 TDV6

BOXYTRUCKS

CHECK BEFORE YOU BUY

- [ ] **TDV6 bottom end**
  Land Rover bulletin SSM71816 covers crankshaft and main-bearing failures on the TDV6, caused mainly by bearing shells located incorrectly at assembly and by shells rotating in use. Listen for a rumble or knock that worsens under load, and an oil-pressure light at low revs. Failures are rare but very expensive, and the UK has a whole industry selling reconditioned TDV6 engines.

- [ ] **Air suspension**
  Run it through every height with the engine on, check it sits level, and leave it overnight to see whether a corner sags. Leaks, height-sensor faults and tired compressors are the usual causes. A compressor that runs for a long time, overheats or slows before cutting out is on its way out.

- [ ] **Electronic parking brake**
  Check that it applies and releases cleanly, more than once. PistonHeads says the EPB often clogs with dirt and a replacement unit can cost over £1,000; owners of the closely related LR4 on LandRoverWorld describe $900–2,200 shop quotes for actuator and cable work.

- [ ] **Front lower arms and bushes**
  A 5,400 lb truck wears out its bushes, ball joints, wheel bearings and brakes. Look for split boots and oil weeping from the hydraulic rear bushes of the front lower arms, and budget for seized bolts if they need doing.

- [ ] **ZF six-speed automatic**
  Feel for judder and harsh shifts and ask when the fluid was last changed. Land Rover's long fluid interval was optimistic; PistonHeads suggests changing it about five times as often. Coolant can also reach the gearbox through the heat exchanger in the radiator, so look for milky fluid.

- [ ] **TDV6 belts, flywheel and EGR**
  Ask for proof of the timing belt, tensioner, pulleys and water pump; PistonHeads advises doing them within six years or 60,000 miles. Manual trucks can eat dual-mass flywheels and clutches at low mileage, and EGR valves often fail.

- [ ] **4.4 V8 cooling**
  The plastic thermostat housing and its coolant tube can crack and drip. Check around the front of the engine for dried coolant, and make sure the temperature gauge stays steady on a long run.

- [ ] **Electrics, A/C and recalls**
  Expect warning lights and test everything: central locking, windows, rear wiper, sat-nav, A/C (compressors and pipes corrode), battery and alternator. In the US, run the VIN for open recalls, including the 2005–06 steering-wheel clockspring campaign.

YEARS TO KNOW

2005 MY	BEWARE	LR3 launches in North America with the 4.4 V8 or the 216 hp 4.0 V6. First-year trucks carry the most NHTSA complaints (96, against 8 for 2008) and five recalls; ReRev

		names 2005 the year to avoid
2005–06 MY	RECALL	Clockspring, fuel-breather and ignition-key recalls; check they were done
2008 MY	SWEET SPOT	US V8 only; seven seats standard; facelift with body-colour bumpers, clear side indicators and Harman/Kardon upgrade. ReRev rates 2008–09 the most reliable LR3s, and they log the fewest NHTSA complaints
2009	SWEET SPOT	Final year; Discovery 4 / LR4 replaces it in September 2009

RECALLS TO ASK ABOUT

- ☐ **Driver airbag clockspring wiring can fracture**
  2005–2006 · NHTSA 08V248000
- ☐ **Fuel tank internal breather pipe**
  2005 · NHTSA 05V376000
- ☐ **Fuel tank breather pipe (follow-up)**
  2005–2006 · NHTSA 07V011000
- ☐ **Ignition key removable out of Park**
  2005–2006 · NHTSA 06V131000
- ☐ **Automatic transmission parking pawl guide plate**
  2006 · NHTSA 05V502000
- ☐ **Seat belt buckle mountings**
  2006 · NHTSA 05V501000

IS IT THE REAL THING?

- ☐ **LR3 or Discovery 3**
  LR3 is the North American and Middle Eastern badge; elsewhere it is the Discovery 3. US trucks are petrol only: 4.4 V8 throughout, 4.0 V6 for 2005–07.
- ☐ **Engine badges**
  Tailgate badges such as 'V8 SE' show the engine and trim. A diesel in the US is a private import.
- ☐ **Coil-sprung base**
  The UK/European base model has five seats, coil springs, the 2.7 TDV6 only and no Terrain Response. A missing Terrain Response dial on the console is the giveaway.
- ☐ **Facelift (2008–09)**
  Body-colour bumpers and clear side indicator lights replace the early trucks' black plastic trim and earlier indicators.
- ☐ **Discovery 4 / LR4 lookalikes**
  The 2009-on Discovery 4 shares the body structure but has restyled front and rear lights with LEDs, a new grille and smoother bumpers.
- ☐ **Compressor type**
  Original trucks have a Hitachi air compressor; a later AMK unit means it has been replaced and the software updated.

NOTES

From the full guide at https://boxytrucks.com/models/land-rover/lr3/, with sources. Recalls follow the VIN: check at nhtsa.gov/recalls. General information only, not a professional inspection; see boxytrucks.com/about/disclaimer/. © BoxyTrucks